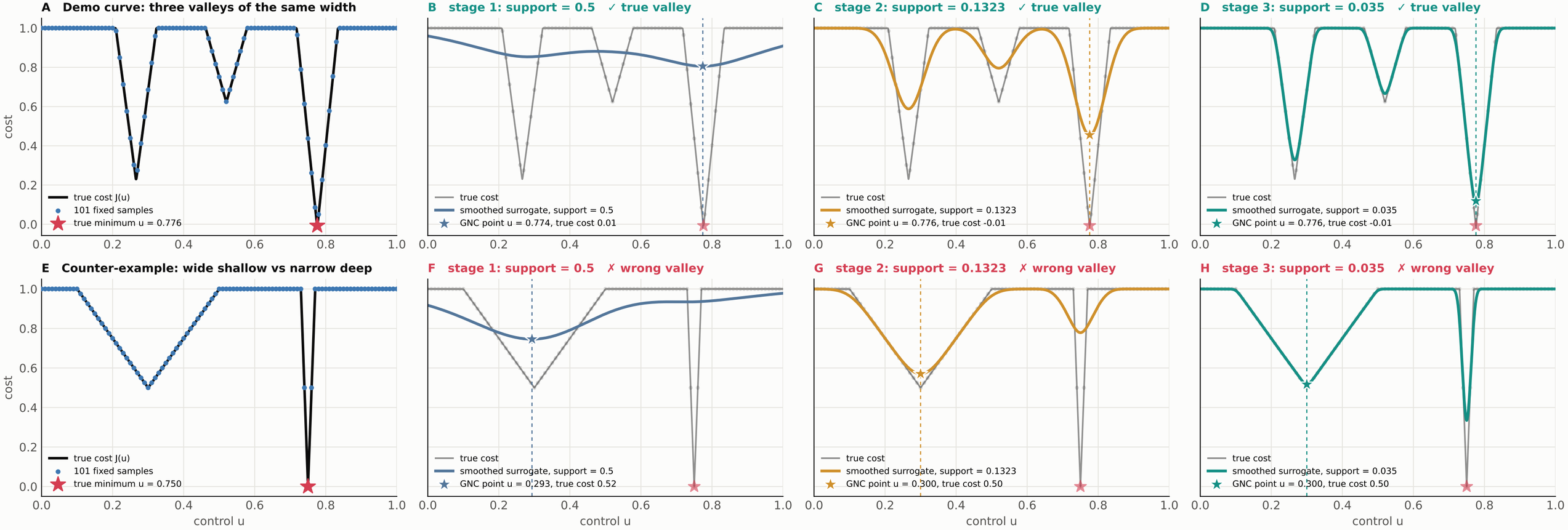
Wendland kernel-surrogate GNC, 3 stages: same 101 samples at every stage, support radius 0.5 → 0.1323 → 0.035

Top: the demo's curve; smoothing finds the deepest valley because all valleys have the same width. Bottom: the smoothed average scores a valley by its area, so the wide shallow valley wins and the continuation stays there. Red star = true minimum.